



DELHI PUBLIC SCHOOL NEWTOWN
SESSION 2024-25
PRE BOARD EXAMINATION

CLASS: X
SUBJECT: ENGLISH PAPER II [SET A]

FULL MARKS: 80
TIME: 2 HOURS

*Answers to this Paper must be written on the paper provided separately.
You will not be allowed to write during the first 15 minutes.
This time is to be spent in reading the question paper.
The time given at the head of this Paper is the time allowed for writing the answers.*

*The paper has four sections.
Section A is compulsory- All questions in Section A must be answered.
You must attempt one question from each of the Sections B, C and D and one other question from
any section of your choice.
The intended marks for questions or parts of questions are given in brackets [].
This paper consists of five printed pages.*

SECTION A

(Attempt all questions from this section)

Question 1

Read the following questions and choose the most appropriate response from the choices given below. (Please do not copy the question – simply write out in correct serial order the appropriate word or phrase.) [16]

- (i) “Then like a Roman bear the truth I tell: For certain she is dead, and by strange manner.”
Identify the speaker of the quoted sentence.
(a) Brutus (b) Caesar
(c) Messala (d) Cassius
- (ii) Select the option that shows the correct relationship between statements (1) and (2) from *Julius Caesar*:
Statement 1: Cassius thought that their army was defeated by Octavius and Antony.
Statement 2: Cassius orders Pindarus to stab him.
(a) Statement 1 is the cause for Statement 2.
(b) Statements 1 and 2 are independent of each other.
(c) Statement 2 is the cause for Statement 1.
(d) Statement 1 is an example of Statement 2.
- (iii) Choose the option that has a similar literary device as in the line quoted below:
But I am constant as the northern star...
(a) ‘You show’d your teeth like apes, and fawn’d like hounds’
(b) ‘The posture of your blows are yet unknown’
(c) ‘Even so great men great losses should endure’
(d) ‘Bring him the triumph home unto his house’
- (iv) Why does Brutus allow Antony to speak at Caesar’s funeral?
(a) He believes that Antony will provoke the Romans against the conspirators.
(b) He thinks it will show that their motives were honourable.
(c) He wishes to honour Caesar’s memory.
(d) He feels pressured by the other conspirators.

- (v) Choose the option that lists the sequence of events in the correct order:
1. Octavius says that the brother of Lepidus must die.
 2. Antony tells Octavius that they should decide how covert matters may be disclosed.
 3. Antony sends Lepidus on an errand to retrieve Caesar's will.
 4. Octavius says that Lepidus is a tried and valiant soldier.
- (a) 2,3,1,4 (b) 1,3,4,2
(c) 1,4,3,2 (d) 4,1,3,2
- (vi) Which of the following is NOT an example of personification?
- (a) Antony says, "Fortune is merry, and in this mood will give us anything."
(b) Brutus says, "But hollow men, like horses hot at hand make gallant show."
(c) Caesar says, "Danger knows full well that Caesar is more dangerous than he."
(d) Brutus says, "The deep of night is crept upon our talk."
- (vii) How are the spirits/phantoms described in the poem *Haunted Houses*?
- (a) calm (b) mischievous
(c) fearful (d) haunting
- (viii) Select the option that shows the correct relationship between Statements (1) and (2) from the poem *When the Great Trees Fall*:
- Statement 1: When great trees fall, rocks on the distant hills shudder.
Statement 2: When great trees fall, elephants recoil into silence.
- (a) Statement 1 is true, Statement 2 is false.
(b) Statement 1 is false, Statement 2 is true.
(c) Statement 1 is an analogy for Statement 2.
(d) Statement 1 is the reason for Statement 2.
- (ix) What is the underlying message in Maya Angelou's poem *When Great Trees Fall*?
- (a) The grief caused by the loss of a mighty tree affects all life forms in the world.
(b) The loss of an important figure leaves a void in the lives of those left behind.
(c) The death of a large tree symbolizes the end of an era in the forest.
(d) The fall of a great tree signifies the permanent disruption of harmony in nature.
- (x) Which of the following cities are referred to in *The Power of Music* by Sukumar Ray?
- (i) Mumbai
(ii) Delhi
(iii) Lahore
(iv) Burma
- (a) (i) and (iv) (b) (ii) and (iv)
(c) (i) and (iii) (d) (ii) and (iii)
- (xi) *He sings as though he staked his life, he sings
as though he's hell bent;*
What does the phrase 'hell-bent' mean in the poem *The Power of Music*?
- (a) carefree
(b) indecisive
(c) reluctant
(d) determined

- (xii) Choose the option that lists the sequence of events from the short story *With the Photographer* in the correct order:
1. The photographer rolled a machine into the middle of the room and crawled into it from behind.
 2. The narrator waited for an hour for his photograph to be clicked.
 3. The photographer asked the narrator to droop his ears a little more.
 4. The narrator was called on Saturday to see the proof of the photograph.
- (a) 2,3,1,4 (b) 1,3,4,2
(c) 2,1,3,4 (d) 4,1,3,2
- (xiii) Select the option that shows the correct relationship between statements (1) and (2) from the story *With the Photographer*
- Statement 1: The photographer retouched and made modification to the narrator's photograph.
- Statement 2: The photographer believed that the narrator's natural look was not proper.
- (a) Statement 1 is true and Statement 2 is false.
(b) Statement 2 is the cause for Statement 1.
(c) Statement 2 is false and Statement 1 is true.
(d) Statements 1 and 2 are independent of each other.
- (xiv) As mentioned in the short story *The Pedestrian*, the people inside their houses were _____ towards the world outside.
- (a) anxious (b) attentive
(c) indifferent (d) connected
- (xv) As mentioned in the short story *The Pedestrian*, where did Mr. Mead live?
- (a) James North Street
(b) Saint John's eleventh Street
(c) Eleven South Saint James Street
(d) Ten South Saint Street
- (xvi) Which of the following statements from the short story '*The Elevator*' is NOT true?
- (a) Martin was bullied at school.
(b) Martin felt nervous and trapped inside the elevator.
(c) Martin was a thin and ten-year old boy.
(d) Martin broke his leg while running down the stairs.

SECTION B

DRAMA

(JULIUS CAESAR – Shakespeare)

Question 2

Read the extract below and answer the questions that follow:

Brutus: As Caesar loved me, I weep for him; as he was fortunate, I rejoice at it; as he was valiant, I honour him; but, as he was ambitious, I slew him.

- Where does the scene take place? Who is Brutus addressing? Why did Brutus stab Caesar despite honouring him? [3]
- Mention two conditions which Brutus had asked Antony to follow while giving his speech. Who had requested Brutus not to allow Antony to speak? [3]
- State three arguments put forward by Antony in the beginning of his speech to prove that Caesar was not 'ambitious'. [3]

- (iv) According to Caesar's will, what had he left behind for the Romans? [3]
- (v) What characteristic feature of the listeners is highlighted in this scene? Based on this scene, give a character trait of Antony with suitable justification. How does this scene contribute towards the overall development of the plot? [4]

Question 3

Read the extract below and answer the questions that follow:

*Cassius: Messala,
This is my birthday; as this very day
Was Cassius born. Give me thy hand, Messala:
Be thou my witness that against my will,
(As Pompey was) am I compell'd to set
Upon one battle all our liberties.*

- (i) Where is the scene taking place? How did Cassius describe Octavius and Antony right before this extract? [3]
- (ii) Whose philosophy did Cassius strongly follow earlier? Why does he discard this philosophy now? What is Cassius' present state of mind? [3]
- (iii) While coming from Sardis, what had Cassius witnessed that made him believe that the outcome of the battle would be dangerous? [3]
- (iv) Explain what does Brutus mean by "*But this same day must end that work the ides of March begun.*" According to Brutus, why would he never go 'bound' to Rome even if they lose the battle? [3]
- (v) What did Brutus say about parting from Cassius? Based on this scene, give any one character trait of Brutus with suitable justification. [4]

SECTION C

PROSE- SHORT STORIES

(Treasure Chest- A Collection of ICSE Poems and Short Stories)

Question 4

Read the extract below and answer the questions that follow:

"It was in honor of this last lesson that he had put on his fine Sunday-clothes, and now I understood why the old men of the village were sitting there in the back of the room."

- (i) Who do 'I' and 'he' refer to in the extract? Why was 'I' in great dread of a scolding that day? [3]
- (ii) Describe the '*Sunday-clothes*'. On which special days did 'he' wear those clothes? [3]
- (iii) Which villagers were sitting on the back benches of the class? Why were they sitting there? [3]
- (iv) What strange thing about the school ambience did 'I' observe as soon as he entered the school on that day? How was the scene different on other days? [3]
- (v) What kind of a pupil was 'I' earlier? What was the most important lesson he had learnt? If you had to give this story an alternative title, what would that be? Justify. [4]

Question 5

Read the extract below and answer the questions that follow:

School is another thing Nana and my mother discussed often and appeared to have different ideas about. Nana thought it would be a waste of time. I never understood what she meant. My mother seemed to know – and disagreed.

- (i) Where is the story set? Name the narrator of the story. According to Nana, what problem did the narrator have? [3]
- (ii) What did Nana think about the education of girls? What regret did the narrator's mother have about her own life? What did the mother wish for the narrator? [3]

- (iii) How far was the small town from the narrator's village? How did Nana react when the narrator told her about participating in the district games? [3]
- (iv) What prize did the narrator win in the district games? How did Nana behave soon after the narrator won the cup? How did Nana's perception change after that? [3]
- (v) "*The Girl Who Can*" is the story of a girl who rises above the pressures of social criticism. Discuss this statement with the help of textual reference. What lesson did you learn from this story? Give a suitable character trait of the narrator's mother. [4]

SECTION D

POETRY

(Treasure Chest- A Collection of ICSE Poems and Short Stories)

Question 6

Read the extract below and answer the questions that follow:

*It faltered: I could see it hesitate;
Then in the middle of the open sheet
Cower down in desperation to accept
Whatever I accorded it of fate.*

- (i) Why is the mite called a 'speck'? What detail about the mite's physical appearance does the speaker find remarkable? Why do you think the mite hesitated? [3]
- (ii) Which actions of the mite made the speaker realise that the mite had a mind of its own as well as intelligence? [3]
- (iii) What did the mite do in the middle of the open sheet? Why did it do that? Give any one example from the poem to prove that the mite did not want to die. [3]
- (iv) What does the speaker finally do with the mite? Why did he do that? What does this tell us about the speaker? [3]
- (v) If you were to give an alternative title to the poem, what would it be and why? Give one theme of the poem with suitable justification. [4]

Question 7

Read the extract below and answer the questions that follow:

*King, ladies, lovers, all look on; the occasion is divine;
I'll drop my glove, to prove his love; great glory will be mine.*

- (i) Describe the fight of the lions in the pit. [3]
- (ii) Name the Count. What strange thing did the lady do? [3]
- (iii) What did the Count do soon after the lady's strange act? [3]
- (iv) Which word has been used in the poem to describe the King? Mention the reaction and opinion of the King after the Count's action. [3]
- (v) Point out one character trait each for the Count and his beloved. What message is conveyed through the poem? If you had to change the ending of this poem, how would you change it? [4]